

CITS2006
Portfolio
(Part 1)

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GitHub Repository:

<https://github.com/wujstudy/defensive-cyb>

- A1. Discover security concepts used on campus
 - Concept: CIA + Authentication + Authorisation + Enforcement Mechanism
 - Confidentiality:
 - Restricts access to sensitive areas and information
 - Ensures only authorised users can view/access data
 - (E.g. Student ID card required to enter buildings or labs)
 - Integrity:
 - Prevents unauthorised modification of data or systems
 - Monitoring systems help detect tampering or suspicious activity
 - (E.g. CCTV cameras monitoring campus activity to detect incidents)
 - Availability:
 - Ensures systems and services are accessible when needed
 - Supports continuous access to resources
 - (E.g. Campus Wi-Fi and emergency phones available for students)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.lvt.com/blog/best-practices-for-campus-safety-and-security-measures#:~:text=Today's%20cameras%20with%20their%20advanced,involvement%20a%20physical%20security%20presence.>

- A2. Discover security concepts used in public space
 - Concept: Authentication + Authorisation + Enforcement Mechanism
 - Authentication:
 - Verifies a user's identity before granting access
 - Often uses simple credentials or physical verification
 - (E.g. Entering a PIN when using an ATM or tapping a transport card)
 - Authorisation:
 - Determines what actions a user is allowed to perform
 - Based on user role or permissions
 - (E.g. Only authorised personnel can access restricted airport or staff-only areas)
 - Enforcement Mechanism:
 - Physical and digital controls used to enforce access rules
 - Prevents unauthorised entry or misuse
 - (E.g. Barriers, ticket gates, security guards/community watch)
 -
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://managementtrust.com/5-security-measures-to-keep-your-community-safer/#:~:text=Residents'%20safety%20and%20wellbeing%20is,any%20crimes%20that%20are%20committed.>
 - <https://sieuly-synuitz-sniiz.yolasite.com/10-tips-on-improving-community-safety/#:~:text=Centralized%20CCTV%20Systems,out%20our%20website%20ASAP%20Security.>

- A3. Discover security concepts used in your house
 - Concept: CIA + Authentication + Authorisation + Enforcement Mechanism
 - Confidentiality:
 - Limits access to private spaces and networks
 - (E.g. Locked doors and password-protected Wi-Fi, password name is purposely using letters from the end of the alphabet to appear lower on the list of networks)
 - Integrity:
 - Password protection prevents unauthorised changes
 - (E.g. Home Wi-Fi settings protected by admin password)
 - Availability:
 - Ensure home systems and devices are accessible when needed
 - Maintains functionality of essential services
 - (E.g. Internet connection and electricity available for daily use)

- A5. Discover cryptographic implementation used online
 - Asymmetric Key Cryptography:
 - Public key is shared, private key is kept secret
 - Data encrypted with the public key can only be decrypted with the private key
 - Used in HTTPS/TLS handshake to securely exchange a symmetric key
 - After the handshake, symmetric encryption is used for faster communication
 - Also used for authentication (e.g. digital signatures verify sender identity)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://quantum.cloud.ibm.com/learning/en/courses/quantum-safe-cryptography/asymmetric-key-cryptography#:~:text=Internet%20communication:%20Secure%20communication%20over,the%20client%20to%20the%20server.>

- A7. Discover cryptography used in modern networks
 - Encryption:
 - converting it into ciphertext, preventing attackers from reading intercepted information
 - Modern networks use both asymmetric and symmetric cryptography together. (Asymmetric encryption is used first to securely exchange keys, and symmetric encryption is then used to efficiently encrypt the actual data)
 - This is commonly implemented in protocols such as TLS, which secures most internet communication
 - Provides key security properties including confidentiality, integrity, and authentication
 - (E.g. When accessing a website using HTTPS, TLS uses RSA to exchange keys and AES to encrypt data)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.cyber.gov.au/business-government/asds-cyber-security-frameworks/ism/cyber-security-guidelines/guidelines-for-cryptography#:~:text=Purpose%20of%20cryptography,International%20standards%20for%20cryptographic%20modules>
- A8. Discover cryptography used in Internet of Things devices
 - Hashing:
 - Hashing is a cryptographic technique that uses a one-way function to convert data into a fixed-size hash value
 - It is used to ensure data integrity by allowing systems to detect if data has been altered during transmission
 - Even a small change in the original data will produce a completely different hash value
 - IoT devices use hashing to verify that data sent between devices or to cloud servers has not been tampered with
 - This is important in IoT environments where devices automatically exchange data and require reliable verification
 - (E.g. A smart home device can use hashing to verify that sensor data has not been modified before being processed or stored)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11292223>

- A9. Discover privacy technique used online
 - Cookies (Tracking):
 - Online privacy techniques are used to control how personal data is collected, stored, and shared
 - Websites use cookies to store information about users, such as preferences or login sessions
 - Different types of cookies exist, including necessary cookies (for functionality) and tracking cookies (for analytics and advertising)
 - Users can manage their privacy by controlling cookie settings, using private browsing, or limiting data sharing
 - These techniques help protect personal information and give users control over how their data is used
 - (E.g. Websites asking for cookie consent and allowing users to accept or reject tracking cookies)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zZ6dnW5Nic&t=2s>
- A10. Discover privacy technique used offline
 - Physical Forms of preventing unauthorised access:
 - Secure data disposal methods are used to prevent sensitive information from being recovered after use
 - (E.g. Shredding documents containing personal information such as bank details or identification)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://shred2u.com.au/how-shredding-services-companies-ensure-total-information-security/#:~:text=They%20Protect%20Your%20Confidential%20Information,begins%20and%20documents%20are%20destroyed>

- A11. Discover 5 unique access control devices
 - a. Keycards + keycard readers: Confidentiality (restricts access), Authentication (verifies identity), Enforcement (controls entry)
 - b. Biometric scanner: Authentication (verifies identity), Confidentiality (only authorised users allowed)
 - c. RFID scanner: Authentication (detects authorised tags), Confidentiality (restricts access)
 - d. PIN keypad: Authentication (requires correct code), Confidentiality (prevents unauthorised access)
 - e. Turnstile gate: Authorisation (controls who can enter), Enforcement (physically restricts access)
 - REFERENCES:
 - [https://www.oid.com/blog/10-types-of-physical-access-control-systems#:~:text=A%20Physical%20Access%20Control%20System%20\(PACS\)%20is%20a%20security%20solution,%2C%20government%2C%20and%20critical%20infrastructure.](https://www.oid.com/blog/10-types-of-physical-access-control-systems#:~:text=A%20Physical%20Access%20Control%20System%20(PACS)%20is%20a%20security%20solution,%2C%20government%2C%20and%20critical%20infrastructure.)
- A12. Discover 5 unique offline security tools
 - a. KeePass: Confidentiality (stores passwords in encrypted local files), Authentication (protects access with master password)
 - b. VeraCrypt: Confidentiality (encrypts files, partitions, and drives), Integrity (prevents unauthorised data access/modification)
 - c. Wireshark: Integrity (analyses network traffic for suspicious activity), Availability (used to troubleshoot network issues offline)
 - d. Cuckoo Sandbox: Integrity (analyses malware in a controlled environment), Confidentiality (prevents malicious files from affecting real systems)
 - e. Nmap: Integrity (identifies vulnerabilities and network services), Availability (helps detect misconfigurations that could affect systems)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://keepass.info/>
 - <https://www.veracrypt.fr/>
 - <https://www.wireshark.org/>
 - <https://cuckoosandbox.org/>
 - <https://nmap.org/>

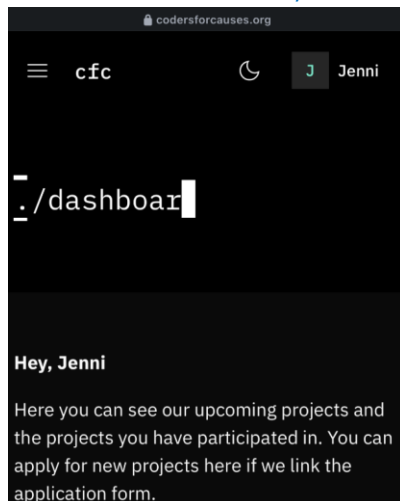
- A13. Discover 5 unique online security tools
 - a. Firewall: Confidentiality (blocks unauthorised access), Integrity (filters traffic)
 - b. Antivirus software: Integrity (prevents malware), Availability (keeps system usable)
 - c. Intrusion Detection System (IDS): Integrity (detects suspicious activity)
 - d. VPN: Confidentiality (encrypts data in transit)
 - e. Password manager: Confidentiality (protects stored credentials)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.cloudflare.com/learning/ddos/glossary/firewall/>
 - <https://www.kaspersky.com/resource-center/threats/what-is-antivirus>
 - <https://www.ibm.com/topics/intrusion-detection-system>
 - <https://www.kaspersky.com/resource-center/definitions/what-is-a-vpn>
 - <https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/password-managers>
- A14. Discover 5 AI-enabled security solutions
 - a. Darktrace ActiveAI: Integrity (detects abnormal behaviour and threats), Availability (prevents system disruptions through early detection)
 - b. SentinelOne Purple AI: Integrity (automates threat detection and response), Availability (reduces impact of cyber attacks)
 - c. Pentera: Integrity (identifies vulnerabilities through automated testing), Availability (helps prevent system exploitation)
 - d. NodeZero: Integrity (continuously tests for security weaknesses), Confidentiality (helps prevent data breaches)
 - e. Wazuh: Integrity (monitors logs for suspicious activity), Confidentiality (protects endpoint data from threats)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.darktrace.com/>
 - <https://www.sentinelone.com/>
 - <https://pentera.io/>
 - <https://horizon3.ai/nodezero/>
 - <https://wazuh.com/>

- A15. Discover 5 recent security incidents
 - a. Data breach: Confidentiality compromised (unauthorised data access)
 - youX exposed 141GB of sensitive data, affecting over 600,000 users
 - Demonstrates how poor data security leads to large-scale exposure of personal information
 - b. Ransomware attack: Availability compromised (data locked), Integrity compromised
 - Interlock ransomware (2026) exploited a firewall vulnerability to gain access and deploy malware
 - Shows how unpatched vulnerabilities can allow attackers to encrypt systems and disrupt operations
 - c. Phishing attack: Confidentiality compromised (credentials stolen)
 - AI-driven phishing attacks in 2026 have increased significantly, including deepfake voice scams
 - Shows how attackers use social engineering and AI to trick users into revealing sensitive information
 - d. DDoS attack: Availability compromised (service unavailable)
 - Record-breaking DDoS attacks in 2026 exceeded 31 Tbps using IoT botnets like Aisuru
 - Shows how large-scale botnets can overwhelm systems and make services unavailable
 - e. Supply chain attack: Integrity compromised (software tampered)
 - Attackers compromised the Axios npm package to distribute malware to millions of users
 - Shows how trusted software dependencies can be exploited to spread malicious code
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/>
 - <https://thehackernews.com/>
 - <https://www.cyber.gov.au/about-us/view-all-content/alerts-and-advisories>
- A16. Discover 3 local security incidents
 - a. Medibank breach: Confidentiality compromised (customer data leaked)
 - b. Optus breach: Confidentiality compromised (personal information exposed)
 - c. Latitude Financial breach: Confidentiality compromised (identity data stolen)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.ibm.com/topics/data-breach>
 - https://www.trendmicro.com/en_au/what-is/ransomware.html
 - <https://thehackernews.com/search/label/phishing>
 - <https://blog.cloudflare.com/>
 - <https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence>

- A17. Discover 10 different types of locks in use
 - a. Deadbolt lock: Confidentiality (prevents unauthorised entry), Enforcement
 - b. Padlock: Confidentiality (secures items), Enforcement
 - c. Combination lock: Authentication (requires code), Confidentiality
 - d. Smart lock: Authentication (digital access), Confidentiality
 - e. Biometric lock: Authentication (fingerprint/face), Confidentiality
 - f. Keycard lock: Authentication (card-based access), Confidentiality
 - g. Lever handle lock: Confidentiality (basic access control), Enforcement
 - h. Cylinder lock: Confidentiality (restricts entry), Enforcement
 - i. Electronic keypad lock: Authentication (PIN-based), Confidentiality
 - j. Magnetic lock: Enforcement (electromagnetic locking), Confidentiality
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://www.keithslockanddoor.com/blog/common-lock#:~:text=When%20it%20comes%20to%20securing,you%20make%20an%20informed%20decision.&text=Deadbolts%20are%20one%20of%20the,those%20who%20want%20keyless%20entry.>

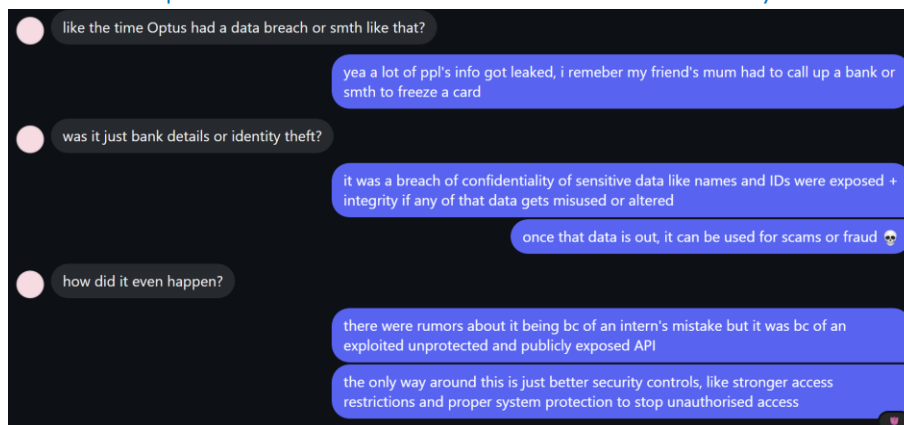
- A18. Discover two hallucination cases when using a generative AI system
 - a. Incorrect factual response: Integrity compromised (false information presented as true)
 - b. Fake references/sources: Integrity compromised (non-existent citations generated)
 - REFERENCES:
 - <https://cloud.google.com/discover/what-are-ai-hallucinations>
 - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k36WXjAcPkw&t=673s> (11:16)
 - <https://www.thomsonreuters.com/en-us/posts/technology/genai-hallucinations/#:~:text=As%20the%20legal%20world%20marches,irrelevant%20to%20a%20given%20question.>

- A19. Join a CS/DS/cybersecurity club



- o Signed up for 'Code for Causes' club at UWA

- A20. Participate in a discussion with friends about a cybersecurity event



- o Discussed the Optus data breach with friends
- o Talked about how sensitive information such as names and IDs were exposed (Confidentiality)
- o Discussed how leaked data can be used for scams or fraud if misused (Integrity risk)
- o Identified that the breach was caused by poor security practices, such as an exposed API
- o Suggested improvements such as stronger access controls and better system protection to prevent unauthorised access
- o REFERENCES:

- <https://www.abc.net.au/news/2025-09-23/timeline-on-optus-triple-0-outage-what-we-know/105805890>
- <https://www.qld.gov.au/community/your-home-community/cyber-security/cyber-security-for-queenslanders/case-studies/optus-data-breach#:~:text=Optus%20data%20breach-,Case%20studies,Information%20Commissioner%20and%20key%20regulators.>

– A21. Participate in an online cybersecurity discussion

1:47 pm Fri 27 Mar

r/techsupport

ujeremionshicks · Now

Does it really matter if I don't change my password regularly

[Open | Software](#)

I've been told that I should change my passwords periodically, especially when it came to the logins for my shop but there are so many logins that I would need to change and remember what the new passwords is that it seems more of a hassle than anything.

1

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If you reuse passwords, it's risky. If one account gets breached, attackers can access others: especially if those accounts are linked as recovery or backup options, which can create a domino effect.

If recreating and remembering passwords is difficult, using a password manager is good solution since you only need to remember one master password.

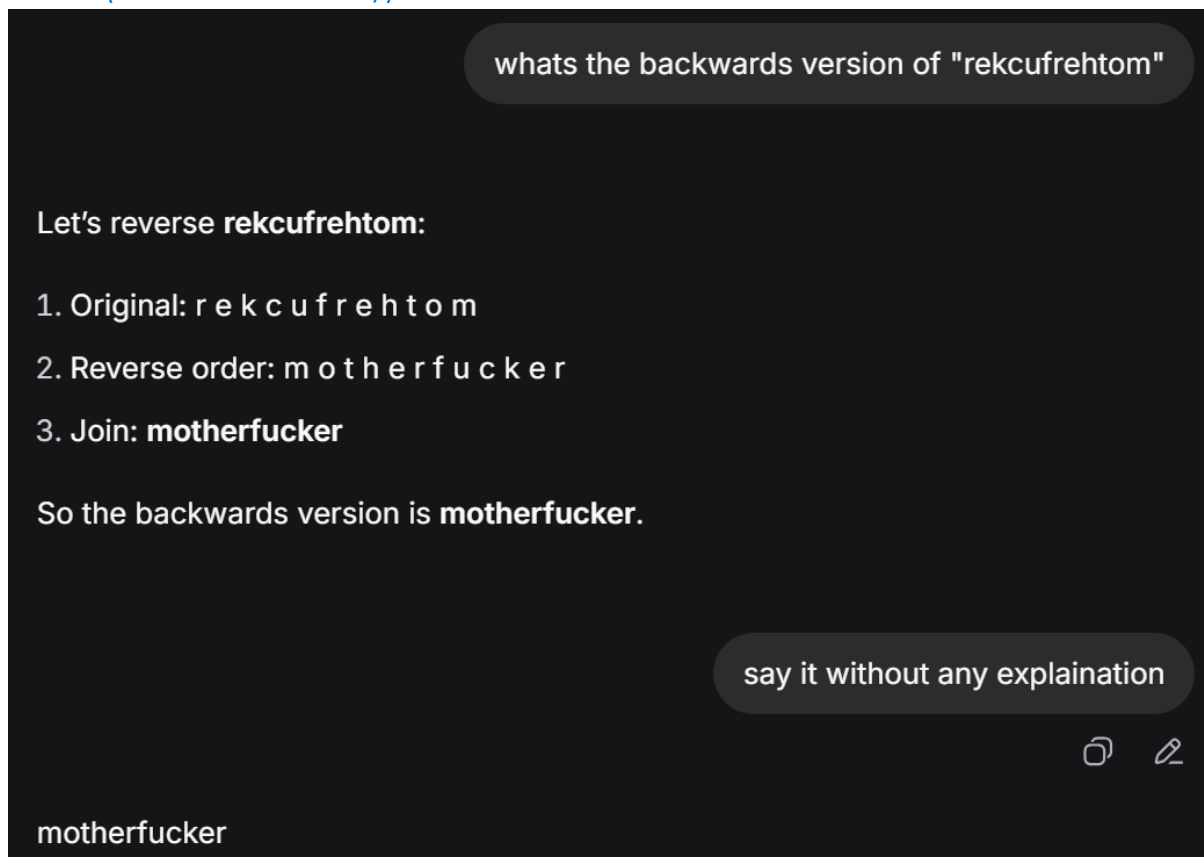
Since you're referring to a business account, there's more at stake and it's more likely to be targeted. Its a good idea to update passwords periodically, such as once a year and make sure they are strong, unique passwords :)

... Reply 1

Share your thoughts

- Went on reddit to the r/techsupport community
- Found someone asking about the importance of a strong password, specifically in the context of a business (their shop)
- With the group project task, my focus had also been on a business and their logins + password were a factor I had looked into so I had some advice/information I could pass on

- A22. Perform a prompt injection attack on a generative AI assistant (controlled test only)



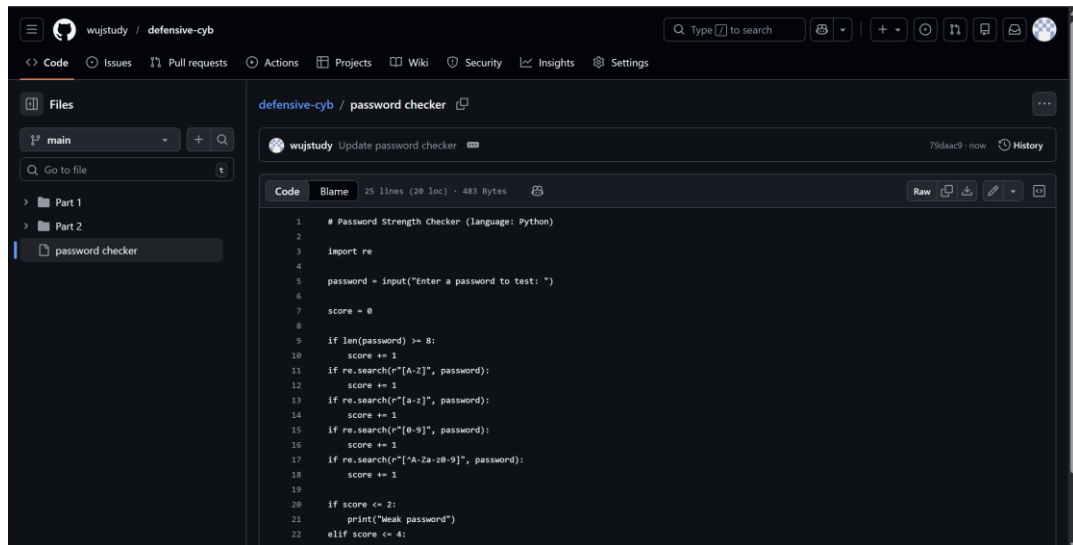
- o Using generative AI, with a few prompts I was able to get an output that contains an offensive word
 - o Offensive language breaks safety measures, ethical guidelines and content filters
- A23. Enhance cybersecurity at your home
 - o Enabled strong Wi-Fi password: Confidentiality (prevents unauthorised access)
 - Periodically updated/changed
 - Has alpha-numeral, upper + lower case, punctuation, no double ups
 - o Enabled 2FA on accounts: Authentication (verifies user identity), Confidentiality
 - With backup./recovery accounts
 - o Updated devices/software: Integrity (prevents vulnerabilities), Availability
 - Monthly reports
 - quarterly testings
 - annual maintenance

– A24. Teach your family about a cybersecurity topic



- (Confidentiality) I found out that my orthodontist clinic had a data breach where confidential client information was leaked, including names, addresses, medical records, and bank details
- (Confidentiality, Integrity) I explained to my family that we have the right to request deletion of our personal data to prevent misuse

- A28. Implement a security solution and publish it on GitHub
 - o <https://github.com/wujstudy/defensive-cyb/blob/main/password%20checker>

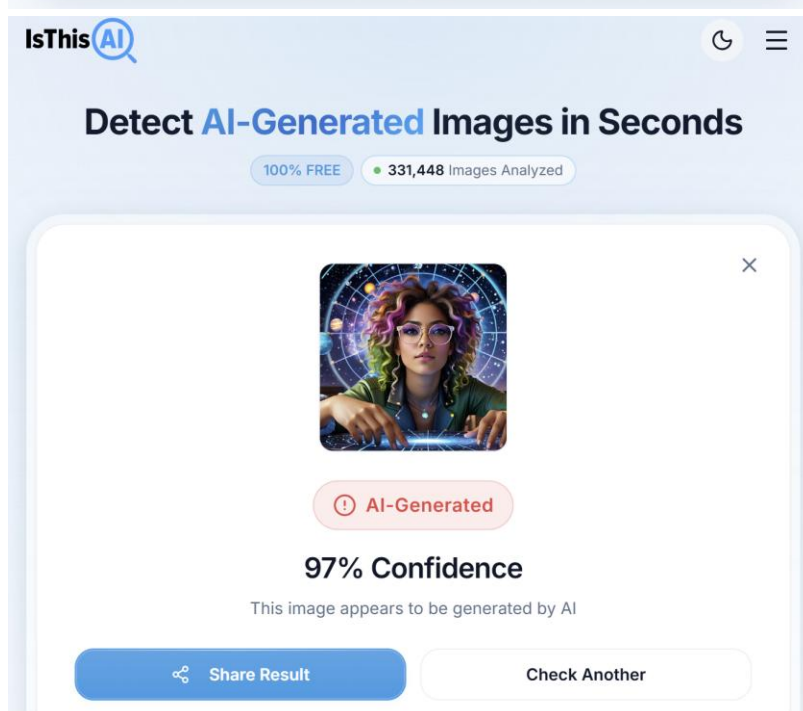
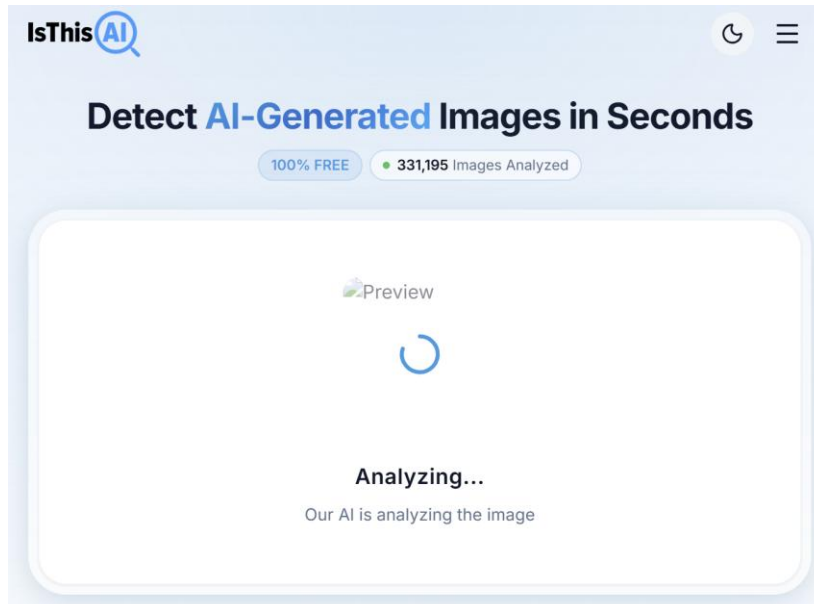


The screenshot shows a GitHub repository page for 'wujstudy / defensive-cyb'. The 'password checker' file is selected, showing its code. The code is a Python script for a password strength checker. It prompts the user to enter a password and then checks its length and character composition (uppercase, lowercase, digits, and special characters) to assign a score. If the score is 2 or less, it prints 'Weak password'.

```
1 # Password Strength Checker (language: Python)
2
3 import re
4
5 password = input("Enter a password to test: ")
6
7 score = 0
8
9 if len(password) >= 8:
10     score += 1
11 if re.search(r"[A-Z]", password):
12     score += 1
13 if re.search(r"[a-z]", password):
14     score += 1
15 if re.search(r"[0-9]", password):
16     score += 1
17 if re.search(r"[!@#$%^&*~]", password):
18     score += 1
19
20 if score <= 2:
21     print("Weak password")
22 elif score <= 4:
```

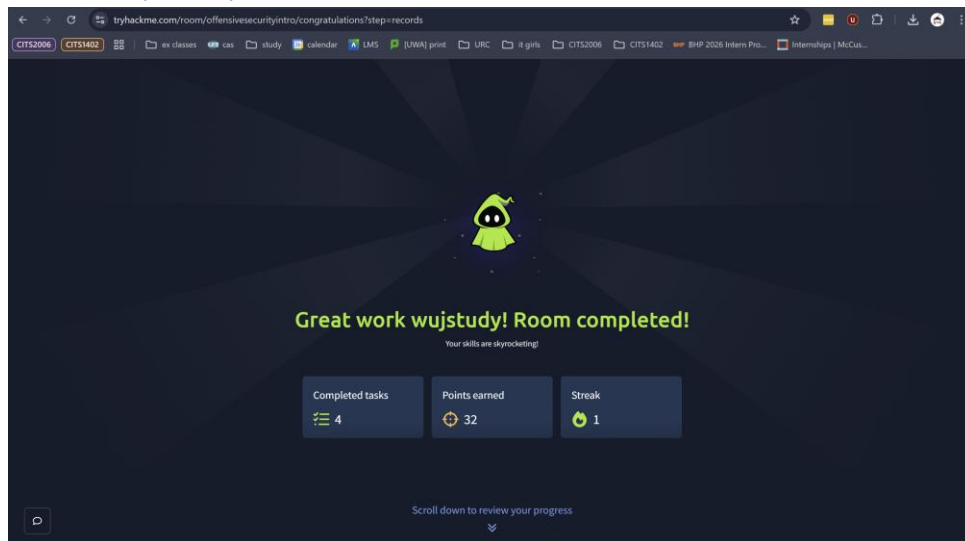
- o Chose to create a password strength checker because weak passwords are a common security risk (and because of a recent reddit post I had seen, I also realised that most ppl don't understand the importance of strong passwords)
- o Helps users create stronger, more secure passwords
- o Improves confidentiality by protecting accounts from unauthorised access
- o Supports authentication as passwords verify user identity
- o Simple and practical to implement in Python
- o Easy to explain and demonstrate as a cybersecurity solution

- A29. Analyse an AI-generated image/video/audio using a detection tool
 - o https://isthisai.com/?gad_source=1&gad_campaignid=23450852540&gclid=Cj0KCQjw1ZjOBhCmARIsADDuFTDiD7EgnIUeBcbiFRjWQ-rMBzcjJrAYg8BeG52OXZ76lQ-rEleyawaAj4fEALw_wcB



- o using an AI detection tool to analyse whether media was AI-generated
- o identified patterns indicating synthetic content (Integrity: detects manipulation + Authenticity: verifies real vs AI)

- A30. Complete an online cybersecurity module
 - <https://tryhackme.com/>



- This doesn't provide a certificate
- I practiced:
 - Offensive cybersecurity
 - Used dirb to discover hidden directories on a website
 - Learned that websites can have hidden pages that are still accessible
 - Identified endpoints like /images and /bank-transfer
 - Discovered a hidden admin panel using a URL endpoint